

In-Home Care Visit Protocol & Client Dignity Standards

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Purpose & scope

Guides CareLink Home Services care workers (CNAs, home health aides, companions) during client home visits for personal care, medication reminders, mobility assistance, and light housekeeping under the care plan.

Key terms

Care plan: Authorized tasks signed by RN supervisor — worker may not expand scope without approval.

Dignity-first approach: Client chooses order of care when safe; closed doors for bathing and dressing.

Mandated reporter: Worker must report suspected abuse or neglect to CareLink compliance within 24 hours.

Standard procedure

1. Arrive within scheduled window; knock, announce name and agency; wait 60 seconds before key use per client preference on file.
2. Wash hands at entry; review whiteboard or visit checklist with client aloud.
3. Confirm identity if new client: name, DOB, address match care plan packet.
4. Perform tasks in agreed order; pause if client fatigued or in pain — document and notify RN.
5. Medication reminders only — do not administer unless MAR signed for worker level.
6. Depart: summarize completed tasks; note concerns in mobile app before leaving driveway; lock door per client instruction.

Approved phrases

"Good morning, Mr. Rivera — it's Ana from CareLink. Is now still a good time to help with shower and breakfast?"

"I'll wait outside the bathroom and stay within hearing distance — call if you need me."

"Your daughter asked us to remind you about the eleven o'clock pill — would you like water with that?"

"I'm noting that your knee was sore today — the nurse will call this afternoon to adjust the plan."

Scenarios

Scenario A — Client refuses shower: Worker offers alternative (sponge bath, reschedule); does not force; documents refusal; RN notified same day.

Scenario B — Unsafe home (clutter, no heat): Worker completes essential tasks only; files safety concern SC-002; supervisor visit scheduled within 48 hours.

Scenario C — Family member directs worker to skip documented task: Worker politely cites care plan; suggests family call RN to authorize change; does not agree off-plan.

Escalation matrix

Situation	Action
Fall with injury	911 if needed; RN + supervisor immediately
Suspected neglect by family	Compliance hotline; do not confront family on scene
Client confusion / new dementia signs	RN assessment within 24 hours
Worker feeling unsafe	Leave if threatened; supervisor + police per policy

Do / Don't

Do: Introduce yourself every visit if memory impaired; respect cultural preferences on same-gender care when requested.

Don't: Post visit details on social media; accept gifts over \$25; borrow client phone or money; perform tasks not on care plan.